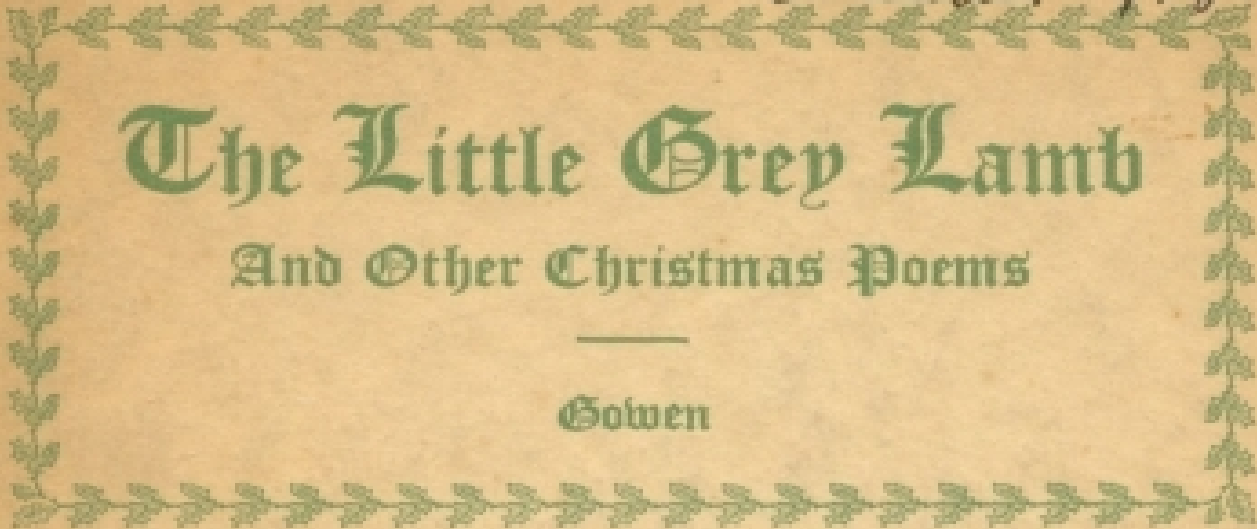


Am. Dominion, with love from  
D<sup>r</sup> H. H. Gowen; December 1928.



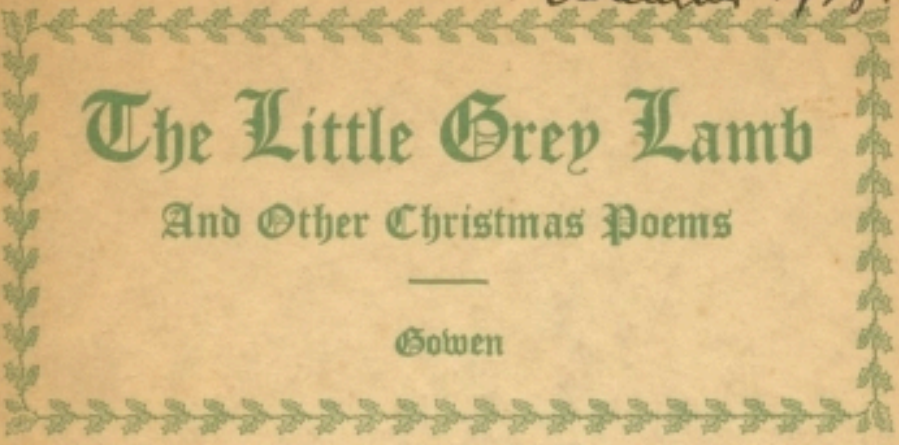
# The Little Grey Lamb

And Other Christmas Poems

---

Gowen

lms Downey, with love from  
D<sup>r</sup> H. H. Gowen: December 1928.



# The Little Grey Lamb

And Other Christmas Poems

---

Gowen

## **The Project Gutenberg eBook of The little grey lamb, and other Christmas poems**

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org). If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: The little grey lamb, and other Christmas poems

Author: Herbert H. Gowen

Release date: January 19, 2025 [eBook #75153]

Language: English

Original publication: Milwaukee: Morehouse Publishing Co., 1928

Other information and formats: [www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/75153](http://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/75153)

Credits: Al Haines

**\*\*\* START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE LITTLE  
GREY LAMB, AND OTHER CHRISTMAS POEMS \*\*\***

# The Little Grey Lamb

And Other Christmas Poems

BY

HERBERT H. GOWEN

MOREHOUSE PUBLISHING CO.  
MILWAUKEE, WIS.  
A. R. MOWBRAY & CO.  
LONDON

COPYRIGHT BY  
MOREHOUSE PUBLISHING CO.  
1928

## Contents

[FOREWORD](#)

[THE CHRISTMAS MESSAGE](#)

- I. [THE LITTLE GREY LAMB](#)
- II. [JERUSALEM, 1917](#)
- III. [THE QUEST OF THE CHRIST](#)
- IV. [WHAT THE WISE MEN SAW](#)
- V. [UNDER WHICH SIGN?](#)
- VI. [THROUGH THE WINDOWS](#)
- VII. [OVER THE HOUSE-TOPS](#)
- VIII. [SHEPHERDS OF MEN](#)
- IX. [NO ROOM IN THE INN](#)
- X. [MOTHER AND CHILD](#)
- XI. [THE VISION OF THE KINGS](#)
- XII. [A PRAYER FOR THE NEW YEAR](#)

## **Foreword**

It has been a habit of mine, for some years, to send an annual Christmas greeting to my friends in the form of a little poem. Of the following selections most have been published in the annual Christmas number of the *Town-Crier* of Seattle, whose editors kindly permit their reproduction. They are reprinted because some have liked one or other of the poems sufficiently well to request this; also because I feel that the treatment of the Christmas story may be fresh enough and varied enough to win the liking of some others. H.H.G.

## **The Christmas Message**

The story is told that when King Edward I of England sought to reconcile the Welsh people to his rule he presented to the assembled chiefs his baby son, just born in Caernarvon Castle, as a native son of Wales to be their prince. The king manifested in the act a very sound appreciation of what is, according to the Christmas story, the heart of the divine method for reconciling a rebellious world to God. For the divine fact which makes the Christmas festival so dear to all alike, and draws together them that are afar off and them that are nigh is nothing less than that the Child who comes to reign in a world of human hearts is truly named the Son of Man.

That the jarring interests of a warring world may be brought together in one common devotion to the best is always plain when we substitute the child attitude for the selfish and sophisticated ideas of men soiled by too long contact with material things. And when men return to the child mind, with its simplicity, its purity, and its ready response to love, the world will certainly be a little nearer to that emulous heaven which yearns downward to touch the earth as the earth at Christmas time seems to be doing its best to reach the skies. The celebration of such a truth is the best antidote for the horrible doctrine of an absentee God and of a humanity left to wander unaided in the dark.

In the great temple, Shi Tenno-ji, in Osaka, is the shrine of the Guiding Bell. The rope is made up of the bibs of dead children, and little Japanese go thither in order that by ringing the bell they may help and be helped along the road to Paradise. The Christmas bells are always guiding bells to all mankind. Wherever they ring, whether they sound only in the imagination which carries us back to the days of long ago, they summon man unfailingly to a Paradise wherein all may become as little children in the spirit of faith and hope and love.

And wherever these bells are heard the heart will never cease to sing and dance away the dust of the world and charm men from the sordidness which keeps us back from entry within the gates of gold.

"A little child shall lead them"—this is the veridical prophecy of the good days to come. In fulfilment of such a prophecy let us share the good-heartedness and charity of the Christmas season. Let us lend our ears to hear once more the song which, though it comes from heaven through the voice of angels, has its message for the souls of men on earth. Let us turn our backs upon the selfish and the discordant till the angelic anthem is echoed back with human voice to the Throne of God. Then heaven and earth shall have become one indeed.

## I.

### **The Little Grey Lamb**

*Founded upon an old legend*

### **The Little Grey Lamb**

*A simple tale of long ago,  
How the little grey lamb became white as snow.*

On Bethlehem's hills on a winter night,  
Shepherds kept watch in the cold star-light.  
The sheep, safely folded, were fast asleep:  
There was nought to trouble their slumber deep.  
    But one little grey lamb was filled with woe  
    For he longed to be white as the winter snow.

Then sudden the heavens grew bright like noon,  
With a light which was neither of sun nor moon.  
And music rained down ineffably sweet,  
As the shepherds sprang to their trembling feet.  
But the sheep slumbered on through that wonderful night,  
Save the little grey lamb who longed to be white.

Then forth from the skies came an angel's voice:  
"Good tidings, ye shepherds! God bids you rejoice.  
In Bethlehem's inn the Child ye shall see,  
Who is born to make all men happy and free."  
Then swiftly they journeyed the Christ Child to find,  
And the little grey lamb followed closely behind.

From his little white heart rose a timid prayer:  
"Is it only for men, O Baby most fair,  
Thou hast cleansing from all that is sinful and bad?  
Wilt Thou not heal me and make me glad?"  
So he followed the shepherds and entered with them,  
When they came to the stable of Bethlehem.

They entered, they worshipped, and homeward returned,  
While a solemn joy in their bosoms burned:  
But the little grey lamb nestled close in the hay,  
Quite close to the crib where the Baby lay.  
And a tiny hand stole forth from the bed,  
And rested awhile on the little lamb's head.

At that touch there passed a wonderful thrill  
Through the lamb as he lay by the crib so still:  
He felt all his sadness melting away,  
As the night mists scatter at break of day.  
The little grey lamb in that holy glow  
Knew he was white as the driven snow.

\*

\*

\*



*May the Christ Child today this blessing bestow,  
That the lambs of His flock be made whiter than snow!*

## **II.**

### **Jerusalem, 1917**

*No incident of the Great War gripped the imagination of the Christian world so much as the taking of Jerusalem in December, 1917, by General (Lord) Allenby. Though an incident in war, it yet had in it the promise of peace, since no shot was fired against the Holy City and the victorious commander entered the city on foot without parade of war.*

### **Jerusalem 1917**

O Mother, with the halo round thy brow,  
Yet conscious of the Cross which looms so near—  
What is the grim surprise which greets thee now?  
What spectre grips thy maiden heart with fear?

What is it that, with half-averted face,  
Thou seest sweep across the holy land,  
Where all the towers and domes of David's race  
From age to age in silent witness stand?

How ill, meseems, become those sacred fields  
The tramp of warriors and the blast of war,  
The gleam of steel and shock of swords and shields,  
The noise of cannon booming from afar!

Is this the peace the angels sang when high  
The glory burst upon the shepherds lone?  
Is this the promised dawn when all the sky  
Flamed with good news from Heaven's Almighty Throne?

Yet constant shines the Star from out the dark,  
Heaven's finger touching earth with silvery ray.  
Though Time tell of despair and misery stark,  
Eternity assures us of the day.

O Mother with the sword within thy breast,  
The Child Divine within thine arms may see,  
E'en from thy lap, the issue sure, the rest  
For man appointed after victory.

And when, in later years, He shall ascend  
The painful Cross, He shall be satisfied,  
And all the travail and the strife shall blend  
In manhood, saved, redeemed, beatified.

O Child, in Mother's arms thus nurs'd and held,  
Give us from love like her's to wake and rise,  
Till from the Cross we see the dark dispell'd,  
The City of God descending from the skies.

Give us Thy courage firm, Thy patience long,  
Thy willingness to suffer for the right;  
O give us of Thy faith, Thy love so strong,  
The vision of the victory of the right.

Jerusalem, encompassed with arms,  
Shall yet become the city of the free,  
And discord, hatred, war, and war's alarms  
Shall disappear for all eternity.

### III.

#### The Quest of the Christ

*The picture this poem was intended to illustrate represents one in vision beholding the Wise Men on their camels journeying towards the goal of their quest.*

#### The Quest of the Christ

In the dark night, while all around me sleep,  
My questing thoughts go backward through the years,  
    To find and bring some worthy thing  
Shall waken life from out its slumber deep—  
Shall scatter lowering clouds of doubts and fears,  
    And crown Love King.

Taking old forms from tales of days long dead,  
Like slow beasts padding softly through the night—  
    Yet, far or nigh, I shall descry  
Somewhere my Bethlehem—so piloted  
By tinkling bells of hope that catch the light  
    Of star-lit sky.

I know not where my search for Christ shall end—  
The kings and priests I question answer not.  
    Perhaps their will is still to kill:—  
Perchance He seeks to walk with me as friend:—  
Or, all unknown, shares the despised one's lot,  
    Rejected still.

Yet am I sure that I shall know the sign;  
My heart shall wake and cry: "This—This is He!"  
    Him shall I find, however blind

And slow to recognize the hand divine.  
He shall His own unfailing witness be:—  
Him shall I find.

And, oh, what joy the news abroad to speed,  
That men from sorrow as from toil who sleep  
May hear the song that Heaven's throng  
Brings down to earth, and so be comforted  
For woes that make strong men like women weep,  
And all the wrong.

Then all the dark shall melt into the dawn;  
Like jewels of the New Jerusalem,  
Earth's streets shall shine with light divine,  
And all her roof-tops gladden with the morn;  
Then every home shall be a Bethlehem  
Where Christ is born.

#### **IV.**

### **What the Wise Men Saw**

*Founded upon an old legend*

### **What the Wise Men Saw**

Back to their homes returned, the Wise Men three  
Reported on the King they went to see.  
Said they: "The star our guide, the King we found;  
Now are we hither come His praise to sound."

Then said the Wisest of them all: "'Tis well;  
What was He like? First let the youngest tell."

"What was He like? Why, this my task  
Is surely easy, answering what you ask.  
He was so young: His was the spirit of youth,  
Ardent and hopeful, forward-faced; in truth,  
His courage seemed to leap from height to height,  
Like golden sunshine driving back the night.  
So I my beating heart obeyed;  
My fine gold at His feet I laid."

"And you, our next in years, what did you see  
In this your King? Pray, tell, what like was He?"

"What was He like? Yea, sir, although  
Not as my brother saw Him saw I so.  
His was our manhood's prime; from out His eyes  
Experience looked, and wisdom: sacrifice  
Waited the altar whereon lifted high,  
Bruised but not crushed, He saw His destiny.  
So drew I incense from my store,  
Bruised too, but odorous the more."

"Well said! But you, our eldest, tell us, pray:  
What was He like? How saw you Him that day?"

"What was He like? I saw Him sage  
With all the gifts that spring from ripest age;  
Eyes that beheld the eternal; youth and prime  
Both clean forgot, with all the things of time;  
Beyond all earthly effort, passion, strife;  
Beyond all heart-ache, pain or lust of life.  
I could not Him my myrrh deny,  
In readiness with Him to die."

Then some, less wise than meet, looked up and smiled.  
Surely, they said, our brethren were beguiled,

And took, for all their questing, but the thing  
In their own hearts for Him, the Lord, the King.

"Nay, Nay!" the Wisest answered; "for I deem  
The King fulfils for each his dearest dream,  
Hear me, for though these mortal eyes are blind,  
Within my soul I seem the King to find.

"As in a mirror's polished face  
The lineaments of him that looks you trace,  
So in the King reflected back you see  
The likelihood of all you fain would be:  
The all beyond your all, the goal  
Of every striving of your soul.

"Whate'er your age or station be,  
He looketh eye to eye, so that you see  
The very self of self which God did plan  
When first He said: 'Behold, I make a man.'  
And with the vision given is the dower  
Of the King's own communicable power."

## V.

### **Under Which Sign?**

*On the one hand is a world of material things, a murky, smoke-dominated world in which men struggle and hate and fight. On the other side of the picture a star shines over the place where the Christ Child lies as the prophet and earnest of the good time to come.*

## Under Which Sign?

Watchman, what of the night? What of the day that's to dawn?  
Is it bale-fire, battle, and blood? Is it hate in a land forlorn?  
Is it benison, brotherhood, peace—peace to the near and the far?  
Shall the earth with its phantoms beguile, or God utter Himself  
through His star?

Blow, O ye winds of heaven, mighty the dark to dispel!  
Shine, star of hope, on our world, vexed with delusions of hell!

Lure of the delved ore, mock-sun of our low estate!  
Shadowed, time-born and time-doomed, on the hell-generated  
smoke-clouds of hate!  
Shalt thou win for thy gloom-spread realm the limitless vault  
of the sky?  
With thy will-o-the-wisp wilt thou quench the lights of Eternity?  
Shall thy angels proclaim from beneath the coming kingship of  
wrong?  
'Glory of hate and ill-will!'—Shall this be our Christmas song?

Rout of poor, purblind souls: Have ye found your Bethlehem here—  
Godless, and brotherless, fighting, in shame and sorrow and fear?  
With your dollar for star would ye seek the goal of your  
heart's desire?  
Greet, as ye bloodily battle, the victor as king and Messiah?  
Trample the noble and pure into slush to proclaim yourselves free?  
Is your struggle success at the last, your victory liberty?

Dark beyond all the dark! Deep Heart of Eternity,  
Whence streameth the starlight divine, from bounds of infinity!  
Love that beats in the dark—beats and breaks through from afar!  
Passionate purpose of God, breaking through in the signalling star!  
Omnipotent Love, finding voice in evangel insistent as strong,  
Streaming forth for our earth in angelical presence and song!

Child, with the out-stretched arms and heaven-uplifted eyes!  
To Thy pure heart alone comes the message of the skies.  
Yet out of thy joy shalt thou speak; yea, to all the world

shalt thou cry:  
"Turn ye, O perishing fools! O turn ye, why will ye die?  
See, 'yond the rolling clouds shines the coming kingdom of peace,  
Where all men shall mingle as brothers and wars and discords  
shall cease!"

Child! Nay, Prophet! we hail thee—Lord of the future age!  
In a world of the sightless, seeing; in a world of the  
foolish, sage!  
Faint not nor fail in thy witness, though the world around  
thee grow old;  
Let not thy faith grow feeble; O let not thy love grow cold!  
Interpret the times to our time; interpret thy hope to the race.  
That the glory which shines in thine eyes may illumine  
humanity's face!

\* \* \* \* \*

Watchman, what of the night? Cometh the dawn from afar!  
Dreams pass away and clouds scatter. We will trust the voice  
of the Star.

## VI.

### Through the Windows

*Some children from within a bare and comfortless room are looking forth upon a wintry night. The world outside is bleak and pitiless. The very church seems empty of suggestion till one notes how the spire with silent finger is pointing to the Christmas Star.*



## Through the Windows

*"It came and stood over where the young Child was."*

Winter—and winter's gloom—without, within—  
The ice on heart and hearth and sunless earth!  
Cling close, ye hapless victims of man's sin—  
Companions sad of misery and dearth!

Cold church, thy heavenward-pointing spire appeals  
To empty skies, all heartless, voiceless, dumb.  
No clang of bells through all the city peals.  
O grieving ones, your very griefs are numb.

Yet see! Thank God for windows! From afar,  
Sweet envoy from a world where all is bright,  
Behold, in silver radiance shines the star,  
Distilling through the dark its healing light.

Over the place where hearts are sore and lone;  
Over the place where priests and creeds of late  
Have stammered news of God and man at one,  
And seen men doubt and sleep, and wake to hate.

O windows, made for light to enter in!  
The Light is there, beyond the darkened sky.  
To reach, impinge, and pass your barrier thin,  
To lift our captive, earth-bound souls on high!

Come to the windows! There adoring kneel!  
Beyond your aching hearts the Heart Divine!  
Heart seeking heart, beyond where systems wheel,  
Seeking, yea, finding! Lo, the starry sign!

O Hand that leads yon Star that shall not fail!  
O Eye that watches through each guiding ray!  
O Home, beyond our habitations frail!  
O Church, complete in Heaven's eternal day!

Be ever for us all 'above the place,'  
Bringing all comfort, joy, assurance, peace!  
Healing the desperate sorrow of the race,  
From all earth's discords gaining glad release!

O Lord of Light and Life, grant us to know,  
Through windows crystal-clear of faith and love,  
Beyond our winter night of grief and woe,  
The steadfast Star still shines our world above!

## VII.

### Over the House-Tops

*Above the house-tops of a big, modern city, with its skyscrapers and its factory chimneys, the vision passes across the clouds of the Wise Men on their way to Bethlehem.*

### Over the House-tops

God knew no wings were mine; I could not soar  
Into the unplumb'd heavens' ethereal vault.  
E'en could I climb the hills, the infinite more  
Of space above had left me still at fault.  
Yet hath He will'd that I should reach the light,  
Accepting steps let downward to my feet,  
That I should find His ladder in the night  
From shop and office, factory and street.  
Yea, when the heavy-headed toilers sleep—  
Life from day's fret and fume awhile immune,—

When darkling shrouds of night their sentry keep,  
The heavens with the house-tops hold commune.  
Then am I one with all the quests of old,  
With all the wise ones whom the stars of night,  
No wandering waifs of space, their message told  
And crowned their heads with aureole of light.  
These loved not earth the less that she provides  
Foothold for souls whose gaze may pierce the skies;  
Time's many travailings and changing tides  
Made past and future equal in their eyes.  
And this the song that, soundless, thrills the air—  
One with the voice of human hearts that beat  
Their living diapason to the prayer,  
One with snow peaks that soar, still waters at our feet:

(1)

Up to the house-tops of Faith, ye sons and daughters of Doubt,  
Up from the dungeons of Time, where sick and imprisoned ye lie!  
    Out from your wilderment waken,  
    Deem not the world God-forsaken!  
Come ye, for, piercing the night, see the star in the sky  
    shining out,  
Splendid o'er mountain and moonlight, Faith's witness which  
    none may deny.  
See, we are here, for your helping, your bodiless pilots of old,  
We whose example and aid all the world's patient pilgrims made  
bold.  
    Slow Science has humbled her pride;  
    She takes us and trusts as her guide;  
    For we are the prophets and seers  
    Who lead on the hesitant years;  
    We follow the spirit's surmise,  
    We hear the voices of night;

Already there dawns on our prescient eyes  
The Sun of Eternity's morn, the kingdom of limitless light!

(2)

Up to the house-tops of Hope, ye downcast sons of Despair,  
Ye whom experience has cheated and left defeated and bare!  
    Back to your childhood's fond dreaming—  
    Truer was this than your deeming!  
Up from the purlieus of earth where men stifle and struggle  
    for air;  
Catch from the roof-tops the joy of the vision outshining  
    our prayer!  
Lo, where we stand, we are yours, whom the world hath not  
    shaken nor shocked,  
We who still hoped and went on, though the multitudes melted  
    and mocked.  
    Yet fainting hearts watched from afar  
    And followed our beckoning star,  
    For God made us Hope's pioneers,  
    To hearten men out of their fears!  
    While the myriads wander and stray  
    In the mists of a starless night,  
    We are steadfast and march on our forward way,  
    On to Eternity's morn, to the kingdom of limitless light!

(3)

Up to the house-tops of Love, ye generations of Hate,  
Up from the man-made hells where ye struggle and slander and  
slay!  
    Up from your loveless stagnation,  
    Up from your hearts' slow starvation!  
Come, for humanity calls to the heights where all benisons wait,

Speaking through stars of the night of the luminous earnest of day!  
See we are round you, your brothers, the soldiers and martyrs  
of Love,  
Who poured forth our souls like a river, and labored and suffered  
and strove!  
From the flame and the gallows-tree,  
From the life-long, slow agony,  
Oh, we climbed up our Calvary,  
So winning Love's victory.  
We followed the Lord of the Star,  
Who died to discover Love's might!  
God grant we may herald to men near and far  
The dawn of the kingdom of Love, the kingdom of limitless  
light!

## VIII.

### Shepherds of Men

*The picture for which this was written shows the shepherds standing over their slumbering flock under the shelter of a great rock. To them appears an angel, his feet almost touching the ground, bearing in one hand a star and raising the other hand to call attention to his message.*

### Shepherds of Men

Shepherds of men—not sheep—  
Your age-long watch who keep,  
Have ye grown weary waiting for the light?  
Are ye resigned to see

Your silly charges free  
To wander lost and helpless in the night—  
For whom the word was given of old  
That all should reach at last the eternal fold?

Or, sunken in despair,  
Deem ye the cruel lair  
Of wolf and lion safe as man's domain?  
Think ye too deep, too deep,  
The human lies asleep,  
And nought but beast awake in blood and brain?  
Is there no inward-turning eye,  
No pitiful great yearning for the sky?

Or faint you at the dearth  
Of comfort in the earth?  
Is Nature with the bad in man and beast  
So straitly leagued the rocks,  
That shelter now your flocks,  
Might flow like lead from furnace fires released,  
And e'en the soil on which you tread  
Prove fleeting as the clouds above your head?

Have all your passionate cries  
'Gainst solid-seeming skies  
Shivered and fallen in mocking echoes back?  
Does prayer in vain assail?  
Do tears for nought avail?  
Does the bright maze of stars all language lack?  
A world where struggles, griefs, desires,  
Make streams in hell but light not heaven's fires?

Blesséd, O Shepherds, ye,  
Who now the glory see,  
Though still your flock for vision unalert!  
Light lifted not too high,  
Nor opening quite the sky,  
Yet quickening skyward yearnings long inert;

Yea, making pathways for the feet  
To find the spot where earth and heaven meet!

Blesséd, again, since, borne  
Unto a world forlorn,  
Heaven's herald comes, yet no-wise alien!  
Of heaven the cross-like wings,  
Yet man's the voice that rings,  
Human the eyes that meet the eyes of men;  
Human the feet that seek the ground;  
Human the hands that scatter light around!

O Star, with heaven-born beams,  
Awake us from our dreams!  
O clothed with light, miraculous messenger,  
Set us upon the way  
To greet the coming day,  
Where, worshipping the Very Light, it were  
Foretaste of Heaven's eternal peace—  
Of earth's unquiet wanderings surcease!

Shepherds, forget your fear!  
The dawn, the dawn is near!  
Though upstart Herod and the Roman might  
Combine with all the tribe  
Of faithless priest and scribe  
To quench in mists of unbelief the light,  
The long-expected King's at hand,  
To rule in peace and righteousness the land!

Say you the vision fades,  
While all around the shades  
Creep coldly on and all your courage dies?  
Go forth, while round you ring  
Strains ye heard angels sing  
When all heaven flashed upon your startled eyes.  
For though your vision fade away,  
'Tis but that dawn may broaden into day.

The Child your eyes shall see,  
As yet laid lowly,  
Not yet full-statured risen to the skies—  
Not yet with tongue that speaks,  
Not yet with arm that breaks  
The iron fetters of earth's tyrannies—  
Is earnest of the struggle won,  
And all life's shadows smitten of the sun.

Oh, once again the tale  
Makes faith o'er doubt prevail!  
Oh, once again the vision wakes to deeds  
That god-like grow and shine  
Till, grown to the divine,  
Man soars to heights beyond where doubt impedes,  
And in one glimpse of Heaven's glory  
He reads the fulness of the human story.

## IX.

### **No Room in the Inn**

*A picture of two contrasted abodes. On one side is the Inn, the House of Chimham, crowded with revelers whose ideal is expressed by Herod. On the other side is the humble crib where angels are finding fellowship with ox and ass in adoration of the Christ Child.*

### **No Room in the Inn**

*The Angel Gabriel speaks:*



Unseen I stand and marvel; mysteries twain  
Becloud my understanding. Here the train  
Of seraphs worship as before the Throne,  
With glory vast, unseen of man alone.  
Even the ox and ass, dumb, with meek eyes,  
With ecstasy atremble, recognize  
The crib where sleeps their Lord. Yet, o'er the hills,  
Back turned on this, a crowded world which fills  
The House of Chimham, anxious but to see  
The little lights of princely puppetry  
Where Herod's palace flaunts its feeble ray,  
With lure, alas, to lead man's soul astray  
From this, the light which burns eternally,  
And brings to earth her full felicity.

\* \* \* \* \*

O fools, and blind! I seem to hear your sin  
Proclaim'd with revelry within the Inn  
Ye deem so sure a dwelling. Hark, the song  
Which shrills so loud the ages all along:

"No room, no room, in the world's wide Inn,  
For Age when the wine of life is thin!  
This carpenter, Joseph—push him aside;  
If he cannot keep up, let him lodge outside,  
With the beasts of the stable of Bethlehem!

"No room, no room, for Mary as guest,  
When Woman is weakness and sore distress!  
As thrall or as toy she awhile may abide;  
If she come but to suffer, why, shut her outside,  
With the beasts of the stable of Bethlehem!

"A child, a child—on our hands tonight!  
Oh, no room for Childhood, whatever its plight!  
Children are cheap: for the travail hour,

Send the woman away to discover a bower  
With the beasts of the stable of Bethlehem!"

Poor, foolish world! How are your revels mocked!  
E'en while ye feast, your Inn is earthquake shocked,  
Though Time but move a finger. The dumb beasts  
Are sager than the prophets of your feasts,  
Who lift their empty voices to the night—  
Made deaf by hearing, blind through gift of sight.  
This stable whither ye the weak ones ban,  
Stands on the rock of God's eternal plan;  
And far above the ribald song ye sing,  
I hear the ages with glad chorus ring:

"Room, O room, in the Kingdom, for the trampled of power  
and pride,  
For Age that sinks under its weakness, with life's full  
fruition denied,  
Starved faculty hungry for service, impatient for uses of  
heaven—  
O enter, but stoop as ye enter, for life abounding is given  
By the way of the stable of Bethlehem.

"Room, O room, in the Kingdom, for Womanhood tender and true—  
Handmaid of God, quick oblation, elect evermore to renew  
Life, with Hope ever re-risen for the generations of earth—  
Enter, albeit with pangs of the soul and with travail of birth,  
By the crib of the stable of Bethlehem.

"Room, in the Kingdom, for Childhood—for children the  
chiefest seat!  
Such shall be dear to the King, He shall gather them  
round His feet.  
In their joy He shall greatly rejoice, and their sadness shall  
make Him sad.  
Yea, their joy shall turn earth into heaven, and their gladness  
shall make men glad,  
As they tell of the stable of Bethlehem."

\* \* \* \* \*

Sometime it will dawn, that Gospel. Then shall shine  
This stable, brighter than the Orient sun;  
And men shall worship at this humble shrine,  
Where, all unmarked, Redemption's work's begun.  
The dumb brutes know; yet, for man's sake I go,  
By other signs to stir him in his sleep.  
My errand now—some few prepared I know—  
To light the hillsides where they watch their sheep.

## X.

### **Mother and Child**

*"The Christ Child lay in Mary's lap,  
His hair was like a crown....  
And all the flowers looked up to Him,  
And all the stars looked down."*

—G. K. CHESTERTON.

### **Mother and Child**

Mother and Child!  
Symbol eternal, and Fact, Prediction sublime!  
Read the sweet story of Love, upheld in the arms of Time!  
Mother and Child!

Read the great story of Earth, struggling up through her  
Sorrow and Pain,

Till, chosen the Bride of God, she bring forth, washed clean  
of all stain,  
Truth undefiled.

Far back in the youth of the world, out of water and mist and slime,  
I see thee, Earth-Mother, arise, both Mother and Daughter of Time  
—

Stern, sacrificially cruel, with passionate spirit aflame,  
Cybele, Ishtar, Isis, adored under many a name,  
Striving through waste and through weakness, onward and upward  
ever,  
Slain for Love's sake and slaying, yet failing in sacrifice never,  
Bearing with anguish of heart, big with the life of the morrow,  
Lifting our soul from the soil, thy Body transfixed with our sorrow  
—

Till, lo, the fair fruitage of life, upheld in thine arms for  
a Throne,  
Opens eyes to the kiss of God, His Child, yet thy very own.

Far back ere the brooding wing of the Spirit o'er Chaos stirred,  
God thought of Creation to be, and His Thought took flesh as  
the Word—  
Child of eternal Love, awaiting the fulness of days,  
Downward descending in dreams, seeking our earthward ways,  
Struggling for birth through the ages, piercing through many a  
cloud,  
Worshipped at many an altar, wherever faces were bowed,  
Or hands uplifted to Heaven in passionate yearning to see  
In thy Face the transfiguring vision of life-giving Deity.  
Till, lo, the idea of God, His Child, thou art brought to birth,  
Making glad all thy brethren to be, and thy Mother the travailing  
earth.

O Mother dear, to whom came Gabriel  
With message like a sword,  
Who bowed thyself in meekness at the well—  
The Handmaid of the Lord!

Mother of Men, triumphant o'er the brute,  
Hailed highly favored from the Holy Place,  
The splendor of Earth's meaning in thy Face,  
Her ultimate Flower and Fruit!

O Babe Divine, for whom the angels sang  
O'er Bethlehem's fields of old,  
When through the darkness heavenly carols rang  
And heavenly tidings told!  
O Child of Heaven, to whom all hearts aspire,  
In incense clouds of prayer that upward burn,  
In wakening throbs of Life that constant yearn—  
Rich Spring-tide of desire!

Beyond the temporal tides whose course has run  
In realms where space has burst her ancient bars,  
I see the Woman clothed with the Sun,  
And circled with the stars.

With feet upon the changeful Moon, she stands,  
And on her face a look divinely mild,  
She holds secure with tender, human hands  
The Everlasting Child.

O ancient Mother, ever Virgin, young  
With youth renewed through all the ages, Sign  
Of Hope, the age-long prayer of every tongue,  
And Victory divine!

Hold Thou that Hope that bursts upon our night—  
Babe by thee suckled, sustenant of thee,  
Beacon enkindled from the Eternal Light,  
For all the world to see!

Sing all ye angel conclave of the skies,  
Who at Creation's birth did shout for joy,  
And hailed the task begun!  
Now let your songs of triumph higher rise,

And all your heavenliest melodies employ,  
To praise Creation done!

And sing, ye creatures from the lowest deep,  
Whose groans have risen: 'O Lord, O Lord, how long?'  
Expectant of the dawn!  
High festival with men and angels keep,  
Upraise from Earth to Heaven the endless song,  
And hail the Babe new-born!

## XI.

### **The Vision of the Kings**

*A woman, with her baby at her breast, is depicted meditating, half to herself and half to her child, upon the Christmas story. The poem endeavors to trace the pathway of her thought.*

### **The Vision of the Kings**

#### I.

O Virginal mother of men, in whose fathomless eyes—  
Soft eyes too familiar with tears,  
Past sorrow and faith in the future both wistfully wait  
The gladness that comes with the years!  
Asleep on your breast and content, that futurity lies,  
Nor frets nor frowns at its fate.

While half to yourself and half to your baby you sing  
The story undying miraculous Christmases bring:

"There came three kings from far away, from far away,  
from far away,  
And o'er the crib of Bethlehem their guiding star its  
course did stay.  
Along the road beneath that star the way ahead like  
silver shone:  
So came they to the King of kings and poured their gifts  
before His throne."

## II.

Then sudden before your eyes the walls material fade  
And melt away in the light,  
While, full in that ray, as on stairway of stars, descend,  
In robes of splendor bedight,  
Three kingships on pilgrimage questing, with Heaven their aid,  
And God within them their friend.  
They move all majestical onward, as eager to greet  
The slumbering Infant who draws them to kneel at His feet.

## III.

The first is the kingship of Love, that walks in the van—  
Of Love that kneels only to Love,  
And vows unto Love a devotion Love only may pay.  
Since Love is endowed from above.  
How else could mortality offer such worship to man,  
Or clay so reverence clay,  
Did Love not know Love as predestined from death to win free,  
Though lying all feeble and helpless asleep on your knee?

#### IV.

The second is kingship of Service, carrying high  
    Its casket of frankincense rare,  
As ready in glad self-oblation to cast at Love's feet  
    The vessel fashioned so fair;  
In gladness releasing, as incense that floats to the sky,  
    The odors of sacrifice sweet;  
Lest self claim the fragrance that clings to one drop of the nard,  
To shatter the vessel so fine to the uttermost shard.

#### V.

The third is the kingship of Wisdom, lingering still,  
    With hands that grope as they bear  
No visible gift, and with footsteps that feel for the light,  
    And with eyes turned inward, from fear  
Lest soon all their questing be ended, lest soon they shall fill  
    Their seeing with fullness of sight;  
Still wise in their seeking for wisdom, yet wiser to be  
In serving the Christ of their seeking on worshipping knee.

#### VI.

Is all but a dream, O my mother, as, plain in your sight,  
    These march on their star-lit way?  
Or see you, through casements celestial, on Heaven's bright floor,  
    Some earnest of Heaven's new day,  
When all things on earth, or in heaven, or in hell's blackest night,  
    Bow down to give praise evermore—  
When they sing the new song of release from earth's sorrow and



thrall

To Him who, though born in a manger, is King over all?

## VII.

Still dream, and with life as it passes still mingle your dream,  
Nor fear for the ages unknown!  
All fear shall your Babe laugh to scorn, however heavy its weight,  
Since man is not faring alone!  
'Emmanuel'—'God with us all'—this is solace, we deem,  
Sufficient to front any fate;  
Though sharp be the Cross He must bear, when the conflict is o'er,  
The kingship of earth and of heaven is His evermore.

## XII.

### **A Prayer for the New Year**

### **A Prayer for the New Year**

O God, whose days are without end and Whose years cannot  
be numbered!  
We, the seeming creatures of a day, reach onward through  
the passing years  
To claim Thy kinship in Eternity.  
We thank Thee for the solemn pause wherein we put the dead  
past behind us,  
And face the new unknown with courage new.

Lift up over Thy bewildered world the sunshine of Thy presence  
That we this year may see the world, Thy handiwork,  
Emerge victorious, purposeful from Chaos,  
Grant us to see, clear of cloud and battle-smoke,  
The Eternal City, real before our eyes,  
Stable on earth, the world of all our dreams,  
Home of men reconciled, redeemed from hate.  
Grant us to see Creation, after travail pangs,  
With Love again made young, young Hope within her arms,  
Her sorrows healed, her tears to pearls transformed.  
Then we, strangers and sojourners of Time, shall gird ourselves  
For the march which ends not but in rest with Thee.  
O hang the lamp of hope above our onward path;  
Give clearer light to understand the things which hitherto were dark;  
Give strength to work the work for which our hands were hitherto  
too feeble;  
Enlarge our hearts to love all that is worthy love, though  
hitherto unloved;  
Whatever seed Thou scatterest along these unknown days ahead,  
Help us to reap therefrom harvests of blessing for ourselves  
and others  
Which Thou wilt garner safe beyond the flux of years.

PRINTED IN  
THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA  
BY  
MOREHOUSE PUBLISHING CO.  
MILWAUKEE, WIS.

\*\*\* END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE LITTLE  
GREY LAMB, AND OTHER CHRISTMAS POEMS \*\*\*

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

# THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at [www.gutenberg.org/license](http://www.gutenberg.org/license).

## **Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works**

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org). If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website ([www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org)), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

#### 1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to



you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

## **Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg**

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at [www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org).

### **Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation**

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at [www.gutenberg.org/contact](http://www.gutenberg.org/contact)

### **Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation**

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit [www.gutenberg.org/donate](http://www.gutenberg.org/donate).

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: [www.gutenberg.org/donate](http://www.gutenberg.org/donate).

## **Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works**

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:  
[www.gutenberg.org](http://www.gutenberg.org).

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.